

INFORMATION SYSTEMS CLUB

University of Mines and Technology (UMaT)

Connecting Minds. Advancing Technology.



TITLE : SEMESTER ACTIVITIES PLAN

1. Overview

This document presents the official semester activities plan for the Information Systems Club (IS Club) at the University of Mines and Technology (UMaT) for the 2026/2027 academic year. These initiatives have been carefully designed to bridge the gap between academic learning and industry practice, equip students with relevant career skills, and foster a community of innovative and forward-thinking technology professionals.

The activities outlined herein reflect the club's commitment to its core mission — Connecting Minds. Advancing Technology — and are targeted at all students within the Faculty of Computing and Information Systems and beyond.

2. Activity 1: No Code Career Program

Activity Name	No Code Career
Category	Career Development & Awareness Program
Target Audience	All UMaT students, particularly those in IS, CS, and related disciplines
Format	Panel Discussion / Guest Speaker Session
Duration	Half-day program (approximately 3–4 hours)

2.1 Background & Rationale

A common misconception among students in Information Systems and Computer Science programs is that a successful career in technology requires advanced coding skills. This belief often discourages students who may be stronger in business analysis, communication, or management from pursuing rewarding opportunities within the tech industry.

The No Code Career Program is designed to challenge this narrative by showcasing the diverse range of high-impact, technology-adjacent careers that do not rely on writing code yet are deeply embedded in the technology ecosystem.

2.2 Core Objectives

- Broaden students' understanding of career pathways available within the technology industry.
- Highlight non-technical yet technology-driven roles such as Digital Marketing, IT Management, Product Management, UX Research, Technology Sales, and Business Analysis.
- Invite industry practitioners and innovators who have built successful careers without specialising in software development.
- Motivate and inspire students who feel disadvantaged by their coding skill level to explore their strengths and match them to the right technology career.
- Facilitate networking between students and industry professionals.

2.3 Program Structure

The program will be structured as a panel session featuring leading tech innovators and professionals from various non-coding technology disciplines. Panellists will share their career journeys, offer practical advice, and participate in an open Q&A session with students.

Proposed career tracks to be represented include:

- Digital Marketing & Technology Communications
- IT Management & Systems Administration
- Product & Project Management
- UX/UI Design & Research
- Technology Consulting & Business Analysis
- Cybersecurity Policy & Governance

2.4 Expected Outcomes

- Students leave with a clearer, more confident sense of their career direction within tech.
- Increased engagement and club membership from students previously disinterested in technology careers.
- Established connections between the IS Club and industry professionals for future collaborations.

3. Activity 2: Smart Tech Hackathon

Activity Name	Smart Tech Hackathon
Category	Competitive Innovation Event
Target Audience	UMaT students across all faculties
Format	Team-based, 2-day intensive hackathon
Team Size	Groups of 5 participants
Duration	48 hours (Day 1: Problem Release & Build; Day 2: Refinement & Presentations)

3.1 Background & Rationale

The Smart Tech Hackathon is the flagship competitive event of the IS Club, designed to challenge students to think critically and apply their technical skills to solve real, pressing community problems. Unlike conventional academic exercises, the hackathon operates under time constraints and real-world conditions simulating the pressure and creativity required in industry.

3.2 Core Objectives

- Provide students with a hands-on, high-pressure environment to apply their technical and problem-solving skills.
- Foster teamwork, collaboration, and cross disciplinary thinking.

- Encourage students to identify, analyse, and develop actionable technology solutions for real community challenges.
- Build a culture of innovation and entrepreneurial thinking within the student body.
- Produce prototype solutions that could potentially be developed into real-world products or social initiatives.

3.3 Event Structure

Day 1 (Problem Release & Development):

- A real-world community problem will be announced at the official start of the hackathon.
- Teams of 5 will have the full day to research, ideate, prototype, and begin development of their solution.
- Mentorship support will be available from club executives and invited industry professionals throughout the day.

Day 2 (Refinement & Presentations):

- Teams finalise and polish their solutions in the morning.
- Each team delivers a structured presentation and product demonstration to a panel of judges in the afternoon.
- Awards and recognition will be presented at the closing ceremony.

3.4 Judging Criteria

- **Innovation & Creativity:** How original and creative is the proposed solution?
- **Technical Execution:** How well is the solution built and implemented?
- **Real-World Impact:** How effectively does the solution address the stated problem?
- **Presentation & Communication:** How clearly is the solution presented and explained?

3.5 Expected Outcomes

- Development of at least 5–10 prototype solutions to a real community problem.
- Strengthened technical and teamwork skills among participants.
- Increased visibility of the IS Club as a hub for innovation at UMaT.

4. Activity 3: Tech Innovative Seminars

Activity Name	Tech Innovative Seminars
Category	Knowledge Sharing & Industry Engagement Series
Target Audience	All UMaT students and staff
Format	Guest speaker seminars and interactive panel sessions
Frequency	Scheduled throughout the semester (minimum 2 sessions)

4.1 Background & Rationale

The technology industry is evolving at an unprecedented pace. Academic curricula, while foundational, often cannot keep up with the speed of industry developments. The Tech Innovative Seminars series bridges this gap by bringing real world technology leaders, entrepreneurs, and innovators directly to UMaT students.

The seminars will feature guest speakers from leading technology companies and startups in Tarkwa and across Ghana, including organisations such as Amalitech, as well as emerging and established tech companies that are actively shaping the local and national digital economy.

4.2 Core Objectives

- Expose students to current trends, technologies, and innovations shaping the industry.
- Provide a platform for dialogue between students and experienced technology professionals.
- Inspire students through real-world success stories and practical industry insights.
- Create opportunities for mentorship, internship, and career connections.
- Position the IS Club as a conduit between UMaT and the broader technology industry.

4.3 Proposed Topics & Themes

- **The Future of Software Development:** Emerging tools, frameworks, and methodologies.
- **Building Startups in Africa** :Challenges, opportunities, and lessons from local founders.
- **Data, AI, and the Digital Economy:** How data is reshaping industries in Ghana and beyond.
- **Career Pathways in Tech:** From campus to corporate: navigating your first years in the industry.
- **Digital Transformation in Business:** How organisations are leveraging technology for growth.

4.4 Expected Outcomes

- Students gain up-to-date, industry-relevant knowledge beyond their academic curriculum.
- Strengthened relationships between UMaT and the local and national tech industry.
- Potential pipeline of internship and employment opportunities for students.

5. Activity 4: Field Trips to Tech Companies

Activity Name	Field Trips to Tech Companies
Category	Experiential Learning & Industry Exposure
Target Audience	IS Club members and interested UMaT students
Format	Organised visits to technology companies and organisations
Frequency	Minimum 1 field trip per semester

5.1 Background & Rationale

For many students at UMaT, the technology industry can feel distant or abstract confined to textbooks and classroom discussions. The Field Trips initiative is designed to make the industry tangible and real, by taking students directly into the environments where technology professionals work, build, and innovate.

These visits offer students the rare opportunity to observe professional technology environments in practice, interact with working professionals, and gain firsthand exposure to what a career in technology genuinely looks like.

5.2 Core Objectives

- Provide students with a direct, immersive experience of a professional technology work environment.
- Demonstrate the real-world application of skills and concepts learned in the classroom.
- Motivate and inspire students by showing them the tangible career prospects available upon graduation.
- Facilitate meaningful interaction between students and technology professionals.
- Build lasting relationships between the IS Club, UMaT, and tech industry organisations.

5.3 Planned Activities During Visits

- Guided tours of company offices, labs, and technology infrastructure.
- Presentations by company staff on the organisation's products, culture, and career opportunities.
- Q&A and informal networking sessions with professionals.
- Demonstrations of live projects, tools, and workflows used in daily operations.

5.4 Expected Outcomes

- Students return with a renewed sense of motivation and clarity about their career direction.
- Increased confidence in the value of their academic training and its real-world application.
- Strengthened industry connections that may evolve into internship and recruitment pipelines for IS Club members.